

Worldly Amusements and Pleasures.

Belong to the works of the flesh.

Galatians 5:19. Now the works of the flesh are manifest, which are these; Adultery, Fornication, uncleanness, lasciviousness,

Galatians 5:21. Envyings, murders, drunkenness, revellings, and such like: of the which I tell you before, as I have also told you in time past, that they which do such things shall not inherit the Kingdom of God.

Are transitory.

Job 21:12-13. They take the timbrel and Harp, and rejoice at the sound of the organ. 13 They spend their days in wealth, and in a moment go down to the grave.

Are all vanity.

Ecclesiastes 2:11. Then I looked on all the works that my hands had wrought, and on the labour that I had laboured to do: and, behold, all was vanity and vexation of spirit, and there was no profit under the sun.

Choke the word of God in the heart.

Luke 8:14. And that which fell among thorns are they, which, when they have heard, go forth, and are choked with cares and riches and pleasures of this life, and bring no fruit to perfection.

Formed a part of idolatrous worship.

Exodus 32:4. And he received them at their hand, and fashioned it with a graving tool, after he had made it a molten calf: and they said, These be thy gods, O Israel, which brought thee up out of the land of Egypt.

Exodus 32:6. And they rose up early on the morrow, and offered Burnt Offerings, and brought Peace Offerings; and the people sat down to eat and to drink, and rose up to play.

Exodus 32:19. And it came to pass, as soon as he came nigh unto the camp, that he saw the calf, and the dancing: and Moses' Anger waxed hot, and he cast the tables out of his hands, and brake them beneath the mount.

1 Corinthians 10:7. Neither be ye Idolaters, as were some of them; as it is written, The people sat down to eat and drink, and rose up to play.

Judges 16:23-25. Then the lords of the Philistines gathered them together for to offer a great sacrifice unto Dagon their god, and to rejoice: for they said, Our god hath delivered Samson our enemy into our hand. And when the people saw him, they praised their god: for they said, Our god hath delivered into our hands our enemy, and the destroyer of our country, which slew many of us. And it came to pass, when their hearts were merry, that they said, Call for Samson, that he may make us sport. And they called for Samson out of the prison house; and he made them sport: and they set him between the pillars.

LEAD TO

Rejection of God.

Job 21:14-15. Therefore they say unto God, Depart from us; for we desire not the knowledge of thy ways. What is the Almighty, that we should serve him? and what profit should we have, if we pray unto him?

Poverty.

Proverbs 21:17. He that loveth pleasure shall be a poor man: he that loveth wine and oil shall not be rich.

Disregard of the judgments and works of God.

Isaiah 5:12. And the Harp, and the viol, the tabret, and pipe, and wine, are in their feasts: but they regard not the work of the LORD, neither consider the operation of his hands.

Amos 6:1-6. Woe to them that are at ease in Zion, and trust in the mountain of Samaria, which are named chief of the nations, to whom the house of Israel came! Pass ye unto Calneh, and see; and from thence go ye to Hamath the great: then go down to Gath of the Philistines: be they better than these kingdoms? or their border greater than your border? Ye that put far away the evil day, and cause the seat of violence to come near; That lie upon beds of ivory, and stretch themselves upon their couches, and eat the lambs out of the flock, and the calves out of the midst of the stall; ...

Terminate in sorrow.

Proverbs 14:13. Even in laughter the heart is sorrowful; and the end of that mirth is heaviness.

Are likely to lead to greater evil.

Job 1:5. And it was so, when the days of their feasting were gone about, that Job sent and sanctified them, and rose up early in the morning, and offered Burnt Offerings according to the number of them all: for Job said, It may be that my sons have Sinned, and cursed God in their hearts. Thus did Job continually.

Matthew 14:6-8. But when Herod's birthday was kept, the daughter of Herodias danced before them, and pleased Herod. Whereupon he promised with an Oath to give her whatsoever she would ask. And she, being before instructed of her mother, said, Give me here John Baptist's head in a Charger.

The wicked seek for happiness in.

Ecclesiastes 2:1. I said in mine heart, Go to now, I will prove thee with mirth, therefore enjoy pleasure: and, behold, this also is vanity.

Ecclesiastes 2:8. I gathered me also silver and gold, and the peculiar treasure of kings and of the provinces: I gat me men singers and Women singers, and the delights of the sons of men, as musical instruments, and that of all sorts.

INDULGENCE IN

A proof of folly.

Ecclesiastes 7:4. The heart of the wise is in the house of mourning; but the heart of fools is in the house of mirth.

A characteristic of the wicked.

Isaiah 47:8. Therefore hear now this, thou that Art given to pleasures, that dwellest carelessly, that sayest in thine heart, I am, and none else beside me; I shall not sit as a widow, neither shall I know the loss of children:

Ephesians 4:17. This I say therefore, and testify in the Lord, that ye henceforth walk not as other Gentiles walk, in the vanity of their mind,

Ephesians 4:19. Who being past feeling have given themselves over unto lasciviousness, to work all uncleanness with greediness.

2 Timothy 3:4. Traitors, heady, highminded, lovers of pleasures more than lovers of God;

Titus 3:3. For we ourselves also were sometimes foolish, disobedient, deceived, serving Divers lusts and pleasures, living in malice and envy, hateful, and hating one another.

1 Peter 4:3. For the time past of our life may suffice us to have wrought the will of the Gentiles, when we walked in lasciviousness, lusts, excess of wine, revellings, Banquetings, and abominable idolatries:

A proof of spiritual Death.

1 Timothy 5:6. But she that liveth in pleasure is Dead while she liveth.

An abuse of riches.

James 5:1. Go to now, ye rich men, weep and howl for your miseries that shall come upon you.

James 5:5. Ye have lived in pleasure on the earth, and been wanton; ye have nourished your hearts, as in a day of slaughter.

Wisdom of abstaining from.

Ecclesiastes 7:2-3. It is better to go to the house of mourning, than to go to the house of feasting: for that is the end of all men; and the living will lay it to his heart. Sorrow is better than laughter: for by the sadness of the Countenance the heart is made better.

Shunned by the Saints.

1 Peter 4:3. For the time past of our life may suffice us to have wrought the will of the Gentiles, when we walked in lasciviousness, lusts, excess of wine, revellings, Banquetings, and abominable idolatries:

Abstinence from, seems strange to the wicked.

1 Peter 4:4. Wherein they think it strange that ye run not with them to the same excess of riot, speaking evil of you:

Denounced by God.

Isaiah 5:11-12. Woe unto them that rise up early in the morning, that they may follow strong drink; that continue until night, till wine inflame them! And the Harp, and the viol, the tabret,

and pipe, and wine, are in their feasts: but they regard not the work of the LORD, neither consider the operation of his hands.

Punishment of.

Ecclesiastes 11:9. Rejoice, O young man, in thy youth; and let thy heart cheer thee in the days of thy youth, and walk in the ways of thine heart, and in the sight of thine eyes: but know thou, that for all these things God will bring thee into Judgment.

2 Peter 2:13. And shall receive the reward of unrighteousness, as they that count it pleasure to riot in the day time. Spots they are and blemishes, sporting themselves with their own deceivings while they feast with you;

Renunciation of, Exemplified.

Moses.

Hebrews 11:25. Choosing rather to suffer Affliction with the people of God, than to enjoy the pleasures of Sin for a season;